SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

8 September 2023 · Shift 3

49 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 41 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 1 question

Q.16

The percentage profit earned by selling an article for ₹955 is equal to the percentage loss incurred by selling the same article for ₹845. At what price should the article be sold to make a 6% profit?

(A) ₹955
(B) ₹954
(C) ₹925
(D) ₹1,014

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 1 question

Q.13

Seven people, B, N, M, O, P, Y and S are sitting in a straight line, facing south. Only two people sit between P and S. N is the immediate neighbour of S and M. Only one person sits to the right of P. N sits second to the left of O. Y is an immediate neighbour of P. Total how many people sit between P and M?

(A) Two
(B) Four
(C) Three
(D) One

General Awareness 22 questions

Q.1

What is the maximum time gap between two sessions of the State Legislature?

(A) Three months
(B) Two months
(C) Six months
(D) One year

Q.2

In 1951, the first Asian Games was held in which city?

(A) Jaipur
(B) Pune
(C) Mumbai
(D) New Delhi

Q.3

What is a government budget?

(A) A report on the economic growth of a country.
(B) A plan for managing personal finances.
(C) A financial statement of a government's expected revenue and expenditure for a specific period.
(D) A document outlining foreign policy goals.

Q.4
Who is the author of the novel ‘A Suitable Boy’?

(A) Kiran Desai
(B) Vikram Seth
(C) Chetan Bhagat
(D) Anita Desai

Q.6
What is the meaning of the term ‘Collateral’ in banking?

(A) An investment portfolio
(B) A type of credit card
(C) A form of digital payment
(D) An asset pledged as security for a loan

Q.7
The word ‘kathak’ is derived from which of the following words?

(A) Story
(B) Narrator
(C) Dance steps
(D) Bells

Q.8
Which of the following autobiographies was written by Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam, the former president of India?

(A) One Life is Not Enough
(B) Waiting for a Visa
(C) Atmakatha
(D) Wings of Fire

Q.9
Which Indian musician got the prestigious Academy Award?

(A) AR Rahman
(B) Anu Malik
(C) Naushad
(D) Bappi Lahiri

Q.10
In relation to the state of Tamil Nadu, the Constitution (Scheduled Tribes) Order (Second Amendment) Act, 2022 will include the _____ and Kurivikkaran communities in the list of Scheduled Tribes in Tamil Nadu.

(A) Narikoravan
(B) Irular
(C) Kadar
(D) Kammara

Q.11
Which antibiotic is considered the first miracle drug, used to treat throat infections, meningitis, syphilis and other bacterial infections?

(A) Aciclovir
(B) Nifuratel
(C) Penicillin
(D) Metronidazole

Q.12
Which of the following is the Fundamental Law of any country which sets out the framework and the principal functions of various organs of the government?

(A) Customs
(B) International Law
(C) Constitution
(D) Ordinance

Q.15
Jyothi Yarraji created a new national record in 2023 in which of the following sports?

(A) Indoor hurdling
(B) High jump
(C) Shot put
(D) Long jump

Q.16
Which physicist's experiment during a lecture in 1820 showed the connection between electricity and magnetism?

(A) John Cockcroft
(B) William Gilbert
(C) Heinrich Hertz
(D) Hans Christian Oersted

Q.17
In the performance of _____ dance, on one side raasa dances are performed by women, whereas on the opposite side instrumentalist play the pung choloms (drums) and the karataala (cymbals).

(A) Kathakali
(B) Yakshagana
(C) Odissi
(D) Manipuri

Q.18
Who among the following was the founder of the Khudai Khidmatgars, a powerful non-violent movement among the Pathans of North-West Frontier Province?

(A) Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan
(B) Abdul Qayyum Khan Kashmiri
(C) Mohammad Ali Jinnah
(D) Khan Abdul Jabbar Khan

Q.19
In which year was the Vernacular Press Act passed?

(A) 1757 CE
(B) 1878 CE
(C) 1888 CE
(D) 1600 CE

Q.20
Which state of India is associated with the famous thunderstorms ‘Kaal Baisakhi’?

(A) West Bengal
(B) Karnataka
(C) Gujarat
(D) Haryana

Q.21
According to Ministry of Commerce and Industry (2018-19), which state of India is the largest producer of Rubber?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Gujarat
(C) Kerala
(D) Uttar Pradesh

Q.22
In which year was the first Khelo India Winter Games held?

(A) 2022
(B) 2019
(C) 2021
(D) 2020

Q.23
‘Losoong’ festival, celebrated by the tribal community in _____, is usually the time when the farmers rejoice and celebrate their harvest.

(A) Sikkim
(B) Jharkhand
(C) Odisha
(D) West Bengal

Q.24
According to the Human Development Index 2021, which group of neighbouring countries has ranked behind India?

(A) Maldives and Bhutan
(B) Pakistan and Afghanistan
(C) Bangladesh and China
(D) Sri Lanka and Bhutan

Q.25

Which of the following statements is true about the Great Bath of the Indus Valley Civilisation?

(A) It was used for grain storage.
(B) It was used for farming.
(C) It was used as the water tank of the city.
(D) It was probably used for religious purpose.

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. France is a “largest” country.

(A) smaller
(B) larger
(C) smallest
(D) large

Q.2

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. Mr Sharma would have left / the station / by this time / tomorrow.

(A) tomorrow
(B) by this time
(C) the station
(D) Mr Sharma would have left

Q.3

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the following sentence. “Do not “turn a blind eye” to all the mischief your child is up to”, the teacher told the young parent.

(A) Close the door
(B) Take pride in
(C) Give rewards
(D) Pretend not to notice

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The mother _____ the chips because they were soggy.

(A) saved
(B) wasted
(C) discarded
(D) recovered

Q.5

Identify the most appropriate meaning of the given word. Hope

(A) Caution
(B) Realism
(C) Cynicism
(D) Wish

Q.6

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Have egg on your face

(A) Defeat someone thoroughly
(B) To be made to look foolish or embarrassed
(C) Making a choice between two unpleasant choices
(D) Reveal a secret

Q.7

The following sentence contains some errors. Select the option that correctly rectifies the error. The tiger was tranquiliized in the morning and keept in a cage to avoid disturbannces by human beings.

(A) The tiger was tranquilized in the morning and kept in a cage to avoiid disturbaences by human beings.
(B) The tiger was tranquilized in the morning and kept in a cage to avoid disturbances by human beings.
(C) The tiger was traanquilized in the morning and kept in a cage to avoid dissturbances by human beings.
(D) The tiger was tranquiliized in the morning and keept in a cage to avoid disturbances by human beings.

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the bracketed word in the following sentence to fill in the blank. She's reading a _____(secrecy) novel and can't wait to find out who the killer is.

(A) crisis
(B) complication
(C) difficulty
(D) mystery

Q.9

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. The viable of life / depends on a pair / of conflicting realities.

(A) depends on a pair
(B) No error
(C) The viable of life
(D) of conflicting realities

Q.10

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. I shall be playing for four hours.

(A) four hours
(B) I
(C) shall be playing
(D) for

Q.11

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined segment in the given sentence. Our team is all "on the same page" when it comes to our goals for the upcoming project.

(A) Be confused
(B) Be in agreement
(C) Be unsure
(D) Be in conflict

Q.12

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Bite the dust

(A) To suffer a defeat
(B) To fall from a height
(C) To remain calm
(D) To fall asleep

Q.13

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who avoids sensory pleasures and physical comforts

(A) Frugal
(B) Epicurean
(C) Bohemian
(D) Ascetic

Q.14

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Chivalrous
(B) Expose
(C) Conffess
(D) Convict

Q.15

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person living in solitude like a saint for religious practices.

(A) Hermit
(B) Cretin
(C) Heir
(D) Heretic

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Clumsy

(A) Jealous
(B) Fierce
(C) Graceful
(D) Nervous

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. No sooner had the sun risen over the horizon “when the birds began” to chirp and the squirrels started to scamper around the park.

(A) when the birds begin
(B) than birds begin
(C) when birds began
(D) than the birds began

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. During the meeting, he went on a long and angry _____ about how the project was being mismanaged.

(A) shout
(B) whisper
(C) rant
(D) mutter

Q.19

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. I had / a bad habit of / waking up / lately.

(A) lately
(B) waking up
(C) a bad habit of
(D) I had

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Chaitnya was _____ from the school due to his misappropriate behaviour.

(A) expelled
(B) xpelled
(C) expeled
(D) xpeled

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Once there was a king named Midas who was granted a (1)_____ by Dionysus, the god of wine. For his wish, Midas asked that whatever he (2)_____ would turn to gold. Despite Dionysus’ efforts to prevent it, Midas pleaded that this was a fantastic wish, and so, it was bestowed. Excited about his newly-earned (3)_____, Midas started touching all kinds of things, turning each item into pure gold. But soon, Midas became (4)_____. As he picked up a piece of food, he found he couldn’t eat it. It had turned to gold in his hand. Hungry, Midas groaned, “I’ll starve! Perhaps this was not such an excellent wish after all!” Seeing his dismay, Midas’ (5)_____ daughter threw her arms around him to comfort him, and she, too, turned to gold. “The golden touch is no blessing,” Midas cried.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) slavery
(B) wish
(C) employment
(D) job

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Once there was a king named Midas who was granted a (1)_____ by Dionysus, the god of wine. For his wish, Midas asked that whatever he (2)_____ would turn to gold. Despite Dionysus' efforts to prevent it, Midas pleaded that this was a fantastic wish, and so, it was bestowed. Excited about his newly-earned (3)_____, Midas started touching all kinds of things, turning each item into pure gold. But soon, Midas became (4)_____. As he picked up a piece of food, he found he couldn't eat it. It had turned to gold in his hand. Hungry, Midas groaned, "I'll starve! Perhaps this was not such an excellent wish after all!" Seeing his dismay, Midas' (5)_____ daughter threw her arms around him to comfort him, and she, too, turned to gold. "The golden touch is no blessing," Midas cried.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) next felt
(B) touched
(C) kept
(D) left

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Once there was a king named Midas who was granted a (1)_____ by Dionysus, the god of wine. For his wish, Midas asked that whatever he (2)_____ would turn to gold. Despite Dionysus' efforts to prevent it, Midas pleaded that this was a fantastic wish, and so, it was bestowed. Excited about his newly-earned (3)_____, Midas started touching all kinds of things, turning each item into pure gold. But soon, Midas became (4)_____. As he picked up a piece of food, he found he couldn't eat it. It had turned to gold in his hand. Hungry, Midas groaned, "I'll starve! Perhaps this was not such an excellent wish after all!" Seeing his dismay, Midas' (5)_____ daughter threw her arms around him to comfort him, and she, too, turned to gold. "The golden touch is no blessing," Midas cried.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) legacies
(B) powers
(C) awards
(D) visuals

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Once there was a king named Midas who was granted a (1)_____ by Dionysus, the god of wine. For his wish, Midas asked that whatever he (2)_____ would turn to gold. Despite Dionysus' efforts to prevent it, Midas pleaded that this was a fantastic wish, and so, it was bestowed. Excited about his newly-earned (3)_____, Midas started touching all kinds of things, turning each item into pure gold. But soon, Midas became (4)_____. As he picked up a piece of food, he found he couldn't eat it. It had turned to gold in his hand. Hungry, Midas groaned, "I'll starve! Perhaps this was not such an excellent wish after all!" Seeing his dismay, Midas' (5)_____ daughter threw her arms around him to comfort him, and she, too, turned to gold. "The golden touch is no blessing," Midas cried.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) mad
(B) hungry
(C) tired
(D) angry

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Once there was a king named Midas who was granted a (1)_____ by Dionysus, the god of wine. For his wish, Midas asked that whatever he (2)_____ would turn to gold. Despite Dionysus' efforts to prevent it, Midas pleaded that this was a fantastic wish, and so, it was bestowed. Excited about his newly-earned (3)_____, Midas started touching all kinds of things, turning each item into pure gold. But soon, Midas became (4)_____. As he picked up a piece of food, he found he couldn't eat it. It had turned to gold in his hand. Hungry, Midas groaned, "I'll starve! Perhaps this was not such an excellent wish after all!" Seeing his dismay, Midas' (5)_____ daughter threw her arms around him to comfort him, and she, too, turned to gold. "The golden touch is no blessing," Midas cried.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) estranged

(B) guarded

(C) beloved

(D) hated

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.16 **(B)**

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.13 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(A)**
Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**
Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**
Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(D)**		

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.16 · Answer (B) ₹954

Equal percentage profit and loss put the cost price midway between the two prices: (955 + 845)/2 = ₹900. A 6% profit needs 1.06 × 900 = ₹954.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.13 · Answer (B) Four

Counting from the left end of the row (their left, as they face south): only one person is to P's right, so P is sixth, and S, with two people between them, is third. N sits beside both S and M; if N were fourth, O (second to N's right) would take P's seat, so N is second, M first and O fourth. Four people sit between M (first) and P (sixth).

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Six months

Under Article 174 the Governor must summon the Legislature so that six months do not pass between its last sitting in one session and its first sitting in the next.

Q.2 · Answer (D) New Delhi

The first Asian Games were held in New Delhi in March 1951.

Q.3 · Answer (C) A financial statement of a government's expected revenue and expenditure for a specific period.

A government budget is a statement of the government's estimated receipts and expenditure for a financial year; for the Union, Article 112 calls it the 'annual financial statement'.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Vikram Seth

'A Suitable Boy' (1993), a long novel set in newly independent India, is by Vikram Seth.

Q.6 · Answer (D) An asset pledged as security for a loan

Collateral is an asset, such as property or gold, that a borrower pledges to the lender as security; the lender may take it if the loan is not repaid.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Story

SSC's key gives 'story': 'kathak' comes from the Sanskrit 'katha', a story, which is also the root of 'kathaka', a storyteller, the name of the bards who told the epics through music, mime and dance.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Wings of Fire

'Wings of Fire' (1999), written with Arun Tiwari, is A. P. J. Abdul Kalam's autobiography. 'Waiting for a Visa' is B. R. Ambedkar's and 'One Life is Not Enough' K. Natwar Singh's.

Q.9 · Answer (A) AR Rahman

A. R. Rahman won two Academy Awards in 2009, for the original score and the original song ('Jai Ho') of 'Slumdog Millionaire'.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Narikoravan

The Act added the Narikoravan and Kurivikkaran communities of Tamil Nadu to the state's list of Scheduled Tribes.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Penicillin

Penicillin, discovered by Alexander Fleming in 1928 and in wide use from the 1940s, was the first antibiotic to be hailed as a miracle drug. Aciclovir, by contrast, is an antiviral.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Constitution

A constitution is the fundamental law of a country: it sets out the framework of government and the powers and functions of its organs. An ordinance is a temporary law made by the executive.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Indoor hurdling
Jyothi Yarraji broke the national record in the women's 60 m hurdles, an indoor event, more than once in 2023, including 8.13 s for silver at the Asian Indoor Athletics Championships in Astana in February 2023.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Hans Christian Oersted
In 1820 Hans Christian Oersted saw that an electric current in a wire deflected a nearby compass needle, the first evidence that a current produces a magnetic effect.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Manipuri
Manipuri dance pairs the Raas Leela, danced by women, with the cholom dances of male performers, who dance while playing the pung, Manipur's drum (pung cholom), or cymbals (kartal cholom).

Q.18 · Answer (A) Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan
Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan, the 'Frontier Gandhi', founded the Khudai Khidmatgars ('Servants of God') in 1929 to resist British rule non-violently in the North-West Frontier Province.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 1878 CE
The Vernacular Press Act was passed in 1878, under Lord Lytton, to curb newspapers in Indian languages; Lord Ripon repealed it in 1882.

Q.20 · Answer (A) West Bengal
Kalbaisakhi (nor'westers) are violent evening thunderstorms of the hot season, around the month of Baisakh (April-May), in West Bengal and the nearby eastern states.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Kerala
By the Rubber Board's figures, Kerala produced about three-quarters of India's natural rubber in 2018-19; the crop needs a hot, wet climate.

Q.22 · Answer (D) 2020
The first Khelo India Winter Games were held in 2020, in two legs: at Leh, Ladakh, from 25 February and at Gulmarg, Jammu and Kashmir, from 7 to 11 March.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Sikkim
Losoong, celebrated by Sikkim's Bhutia community (as Namsoong by the Lepchas), marks the end of the harvest and the Sikkimese New Year.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Pakistan and Afghanistan
In the Human Development Index for 2021 (Human Development Report 2021/22), India ranked 132nd of 191 countries; Pakistan (161st) and Afghanistan (180th) ranked below it, while Sri Lanka, China, the Maldives, Bhutan and Bangladesh ranked above.

Q.25 · Answer (D) It was probably used for religious purpose.
The Great Bath at Mohenjo-daro, a watertight brick tank with steps at both ends, was probably used for ritual bathing.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (D) large
Nothing is being compared, so the positive degree follows 'a': 'France is a large country.' A superlative would need 'the'.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Mr Sharma would have left
An action that will be complete by a point in the future ('by this time tomorrow') takes the future perfect: 'Mr Sharma will have left the station by this time tomorrow.'

Q.3 · Answer (D) Pretend not to notice
To 'turn a blind eye' to something is to pretend not to notice it.

Q.4 · Answer (C) discarded
Soggy chips are unpleasant to eat, so the mother 'discarded' them, that is, threw them away.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Wish
'Hope' is a feeling of wanting something to happen: a 'wish'. 'Cynicism' is close to its opposite.

Q.6 · Answer (B) To be made to look foolish or embarrassed
To 'have egg on your face' is to be made to look foolish or embarrassed, usually by something that turns out badly.

Q.7 · Answer (B) The tiger was tranquilized in the morning and kept in a cage to avoid disturbances by human beings.
Only this sentence spells 'tranquilized', 'kept', 'avoid' and 'disturbances' correctly.

Q.8 · Answer (D) mystery
'Mystery', something secret or unexplained, is the word close to 'secrecy', and a mystery novel is one in which the reader finds out who committed a crime.

Q.9 · Answer (C) The viable of life
'Viable' is an adjective, and the subject needs a noun: 'The viability of life depends on a pair of conflicting realities.'

Q.10 · Answer (C) shall be playing
SSC's key gives 'shall be playing', taking the length of time ('for four hours') to call for the future perfect continuous, 'I shall have been playing for four hours', the tense for an action that will have gone on for a stretch of time by a point in the future. The future continuous as printed can be defended, but there is no 'No error' option and none of the other parts could be at fault.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Be in agreement
To be 'on the same page' is to agree, to share the same understanding.

Q.12 · Answer (A) To suffer a defeat
To 'bite the dust' is to be defeated (or, informally, to fail or die).

Q.13 · Answer (D) Ascetic
An 'ascetic' gives up physical comforts and pleasures, often for religious reasons. A frugal person is careful with money, an epicurean seeks pleasure, and a bohemian lives unconventionally.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Conffess
The correct spelling is 'confess', with one 'f'.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Hermit
A 'hermit' lives alone, apart from society, often for religious reasons. A heretic holds beliefs against accepted doctrine, and an heir inherits.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Graceful
'Clumsy' means awkward in movement; its opposite is 'graceful'.

Q.17 · Answer (D) than the birds began
'No sooner' is followed by 'than', not 'when', and the past 'began' matches 'started': 'No sooner had the sun risen over the horizon than the birds began to chirp.'

Q.18 · Answer (C) rant
A 'rant' is a long, angry speech, which fits 'long and angry'; a whisper and a mutter are quiet, and a shout is brief.

Q.19 · Answer (A) lately
'Lately' means recently; the adverb for waking after the usual time is 'late': 'I had a bad habit of waking up late.'

Q.20 · Answer (A) expelled
The correct spelling is 'expelled', with a double 'l': officially made to leave the school.

Q.21 · Answer (B) wish
Midas was granted a 'wish', as the next sentence ('For his wish') shows.

Q.22 · Answer (B) touched
This is the golden touch: whatever Midas 'touched' would turn to gold.

Q.23 · Answer (B) powers
His newly-earned 'powers', the ability to turn things to gold, are what he tried out by touching all kinds of things.

Q.24 · Answer (B) hungry
Food turned to gold in his hand, so he could not eat and became 'hungry', as 'Hungry, Midas groaned' confirms.

Q.25 · Answer (C) beloved
The daughter who ran to comfort him was his 'beloved', dearly loved, daughter.

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